- Role:

- Role:

- Function/Department:

- Function/Department:

Mid-Program Review

The 360° of Program Management

Bosch

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Senthilnathan Sivasamy

Introduction

Self Introduction:

- *Participant Name : Senthilnathan Sivasamy (MS/ENE-VD3-XC)*
- *Manager Name : Ganeshbabu C Venkatarathinam (MS/ENE-VD3-XC)*
- *Role : Senior Project Manager*
- *Department : ENE-VD3-XC*

What is your job role? What activities does it involve?

- *Software Project Manager for Display products and responsible for overseeing offshore development, resource planning, budgeting, risk management, and backlog prioritization.*
- *Coordinated cross-functional teams and customers to ensure timely delivery, requirement alignment, and quality compliance.*

Who is your customer?

- *OEM : BMW*
- *Supplier : Socionext*
- *Internal : System, Hardware, Validation, Plant*

Module-wise Learning Application

Modules		Been able to apply	Identified areas to apply	No Scope to apply
Leadership	Leader in me	✓		
	Resilient Leadership	✓		
	Uncertainty Management	✓		
	Strategic Thinking & Creativity		✓	
Professional	Leading Cross-functional teams	✓		
	Negotiation Skills/Conflict Management	✓		

Note : Use the tick symbol to mark your relevant responses

Been able to apply

Application of Learnings from Leadership Modules

Leader in Me

Top 2–3 learnings:

1. Maintain transparent and proactive communication.
2. Define corrective actions promptly and respond immediately to escalations or critical blockers.
3. Be open to build trust and strengthen collaboration.

Application example:

- Situation:
  - The software for the customer and plant deliveries was delayed due to a flashing issue identified during software testing.
  - As a result, sample production for PU26-07 milestone was temporarily halted and escalated from the plant.
- Action taken:
  - An immediate meeting was invited with the customer, project managers, and plant team to review the issue and assess the potential impact of proceeding with sample production while the defect remained unresolved and later, we can plan for reflashing the produced samples.
  - In parallel, the defect was classified as a blocking issue and prioritized for detailed analysis and corrective action.
  - The team also aligned on the timeline and defined the next steps for testing and releasing the updated software with the implemented fix to enable production to resume.
- Outcome:
  - The next steps for bug resolution and validation testing have been aligned, and a revised timeline for software delivery has been established.
  - The updated software delivery schedule was planned in mutual agreement to ensure that the overall production timeline remains unaffected.

Been able to apply

Application of Learnings from Leadership Modules

Resilient Leadership

Top 2–3 learnings:

1. Adapt effectively to changing situations and project demands.
2. Clearly communicate the goals and vision to the team to ensure alignment.
3. Demonstrate adaptability while fostering a continuous growth mindset.

Application example:

- Situation:
  - Production was halted due to a flashing issue identified exclusively in the D7 sample, which resulted in significant escalation from project management.
  - As the new samples were available only with the hardware team in Braga, it was particularly challenging to perform remote analysis, identify the root cause, and implement the required fix.
- Action taken:
  - A task force was immediately formed with the core team to review the issue, focusing on why the flashing failure occurred only in the D7 sample while flashing remained successful in other samples.
  - The hardware team was requested to establish a remote setup with the required test environment and to ensure that a camera connection was available for real-time verification.
  - A live debugging session was then initiated through a virtual meeting, bringing together the system, hardware, and software teams to collaboratively analyze and resolve the issue.
- Outcome:
  - With the support of the hardware team, the issue was identified within one day, and the findings were promptly communicated to both the plant and the customer.
  - A comparison of the old and new samples confirmed that the root cause was related to the Head Unit timing, rather than the display product software itself, this was communicated to both the customer and the plant team, enabling production to resume and continue as originally planned.

Application of Learnings from Leadership Modules

Been able to apply

Uncertainty Management

Top 2–3 learnings:

1. VUCA (**V**olatility – **U**ncertainty – **C**omplexity – **A**mbiguity)
2. BANI (**B**rittle – **A**nxious – **N**on-linear – **I**ncomprehensible)
3. Scenario Planning

Application example:

- Situation:
  - An escalation occurred during the SOP phase as Functional Safety compliance requirements were not fully met. The Freedom from Interference (FFI), FuSa library configuration, compiler settings, and toolchain were not managed in accordance with ASIL compliance requirements.
  - Additionally, portions of the software that were architecturally constrained to ASIL-B were not included in the formal ASIL safety reviews. This gap in ASIL-B safety review coverage was not identified during the early System Safety Reviews (SSRs) and was only detected close to the Start of Production (SOP).
- Action taken:
  - A task force was immediately established, and the required corrective actions were identified and discussed in detail. A revised timeline for safety reviews and code deliveries, aligned with safety standards, was defined and agreed upon in coordination with Bosch internal project management. The customer was also transparently informed about the issue.
  - As part of the corrective measures, the ARM FuSa C Library (CLib) was integrated in accordance with the safety manual, and compliance was re-verified through formal safety reviews.
  - In addition, daily sync meetings were scheduled with senior management (Sponsor, Project Manager, and core project members) to provide regular status updates on completed actions and upcoming steps, ensuring full transparency and effective communication of all task force activities.
- Outcome:
  - The SOP timeline was rescheduled from June ’25 to November ’25 to accommodate the required safety reviews and associated software updates. This revised timeline was formally aligned and agreed upon with the customer, ensuring that production delivery commitments remained unaffected.
  - Through continuous monitoring, structured tracking, and close coordination across teams, the project successfully met the revised schedule, and the software was delivered on time for the November ’25 SOP without any issues in production.

Identified areas to apply

Application of Learnings from Leadership Modules

Strategic Thinking & Creativity

Top 2–3 learnings:

1. Demonstrate future-focused planning through proactive identification of potential challenges, solutions, and alternatives.
2. Encourage creative thinking while ensuring alignment with organizational objectives and strategic priorities.
3. Translate innovative ideas into practical actions that deliver meaningful and measurable outcomes.

Application example:

- Situation:
  - Prepared effort estimation for the display project with a new customer by leveraging the current project as a baseline, while incorporating the requested feature changes.
  - The existing solution concept from the current implementation will be reused where applicable, with necessary adaptations planned to meet the specific requirements of the new customer.
- Action taken:
  - A workshop was organized with the system team to review the current project and align on the new requirements that need to be considered for adaptation.
  - The team analyzed key technical aspects, including the new microcontroller, video interface concept, and communication protocols, to ensure suitability with the updated technology requirements. Memory constraints were also evaluated, as the current project had reached its maximum threshold.
  - Based on past project experience, defined criteria, and key assumptions, the concept was finalized. Subsequently, the effort estimation was prepared and presented to senior management for review and approval.
- Outcome:
  - Yet to be realized

    – by introducing new and alternative solutions, we were able to achieve a competitive and optimized effort estimation for the new project.

Been able to apply

Application of Learnings from Leadership Modules

Leading Cross-functional teams

Top 2–3 learnings:

1. Team Canvas (align in People & Roles, Common Goals, Purpose, Values & Rules, Strength & Weakness)
2. The Five dysfunctions of team (absence of trust, fear of conflict, lack of commitment, avoidance of accountability and inattention to results)

Application example:

- Situation:
  - There were delays in the planned feature and bug deliveries for the customer software release, which impacted the completion of testing activities and subsequently delayed the software release to both the customer and the plant.
  - As a result, milestone commitments were not met, and the lack of upfront communication regarding these delays led to increased monitoring and follow-ups to ensure delivery alignment.
- Action taken:
  - A dedicated Docupedia page was created and maintained to track the software delivery timeline, including key milestones such as code freeze, testing completion, and final delivery to the customer.
  - A Teams channel was also established to continuously update planned features and bug fixes for the release, ensuring all developers had a clear understanding of shared delivery goals, scope, and purpose.
  - In addition, one-to-one discussions were conducted with developers who were frequently facing delivery delays to understand their challenges and constraints. Based on these discussions, targeted support was provided to help ensure on-time delivery and improve overall execution alignment.
- Outcome:
  - The team is aligned and aware of the planned software release timelines. A common chat group is actively used to share current status uand highlight any blockers requiring management support.
  - Through one-to-one discussions, key challenges, blockers, and underlying causes affecting trust and commitment within the team were identified. These topics were addressed in collaboration with the Product Owner and Scrum Master, helping to rebuild confidence and strengthen trust within the team

Been able to apply

Application of Learnings from Leadership Modules

Negotiation Skills/Conflict Management

Top 2–3 learnings:

1. Stakeholder Engagement Model (Needs, Expectations and Influencing Strategies)
2. Influencing Techniques (Involve, Consult and Collaborate)
3. Negotiation Principles (BATNA & ZOPA)

Application example:

➢ Situation:

- There was a conflict between the development and testing teams, as several reported defects were being rejected by the development team without proper root cause analysis documented in the RTC tickets. In some cases, issues were marked as “not reproducible” on the development test bench.
- This led to misalignment and an unhealthy working environment between both teams, impacting collaboration and overall efficiency.

➢ Action taken:

- Separate discussions were conducted with both the development and testing teams, along with individual one-on-one sessions, to understand the underlying issues and communication gaps.
- A structured strategy for bug handling was defined, including clear guidelines for bug reporting with necessary details and attachments, defined bug turnaround times, and mandatory analysis updates in RTC tickets (root cause or rejection justification).
- Additionally, it was agreed that approval from the ticket creator would be mandatory for rejected and integrated tickets before transitioning them to the “Done” state during daily sync meetings, ensuring improved transparency, accountability, and collaboration.

➢ Outcome:

- The conflict was successfully resolved through a common alignment between both teams by implementing a structured strategy for handling and rejecting tickets.
- The newly defined process was closely monitored during daily sync meetings to ensure consistent adherence to the workflow, maintain transparency, and keep both teams aligned.

Action Plan (Next 30–60 Days)

3 specific actions you will take:

1. Proactively explored potential solutions, ideas, and alternative approaches for the new acquisition project to ensure robust and scalable outcomes.
2. Clearly communicated the goals and vision of the model year project, including CRQ adaptations, to ensure shared understanding and alignment across the team.
3. Ensure adaptability and encouraged a growth mindset within the team to effectively support and execute the model year project.

How will you measure success?

1. Prepared the software architecture to incorporate the newly identified solutions and alternative design approaches, ensuring alignment with customer expectations and supporting **successful project approval and award**.
2. Planned and communicated RTC features to the team with clear expectations and detailed descriptions, **ensuring tasks are completed with a defined "Definition of Done"** and properly approved by the Project Manager.
3. Organized structured knowledge transfer sessions within the team in preparation for the planned ramp-down during the maintenance phase, ensuring effective handover and **enabling developers to independently manage and support the features.**

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Thank You